I'd like to be able to recall that my burning desire to go to college was planted first and foremost in a drive to get an education. But at seventeen, I think I was probably more motivated by love for a pretty girl and a love for football.

Going to college offered me the chance to play football for four more years. And my choice of Eureka was fixed in concrete when Margaret told me that she'd decided to follow her two sisters there.

If I was going to do the same thing, though, I had to overcome a big obstacle: I still didn't have enough money for college. Ever since I'd begun working with a pick and shovel, I'd banked just about everything I earned except for the church tithe my mother called "The Lord's Share." I'd saved $400. But it wasn't enough to finance four years at Eureka, where the tuition bill alone was $180 a year and the cost of room and board was almost as much.

When I drove Margaret to Eureka that September to register for her freshman year, I saw the campus for the first time and I was bowled over. It was even lovelier than I'd imagined it would be.

There were five Georgian-style brick buildings arranged around a semicircle with windows framed in white. The buildings were covered with ivy and surrounded by acres of rolling green lawn studded with trees still lush with their summer foliage.

I knew I had to stay. I also knew my only chance of doing that was to get a scholarship. While Margaret registered, I presented myself to Eureka's new president, Bert Wilson, and Ralph McKinzie, the football coach, and tried to impress them with my credentials as a football player and as someone who could win some trophies for Eureka's swim team.

Like many small church-affiliated colleges, Eureka was perpetually insolvent. It didn't have the luxury of giving students a free ride. But, fortunately for me, I was